

Elvin (Mingpu) Hu

Master Student at Keio University.

Previously Senior Designer and Design Lead at Google.

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Research interests

Intent-aware and intelligent interfaces, implicit-signal interaction, foundational interface structures, generative and personalized UI, accessibility

Education

Keio University Graduate School of Media Design (KMD) 2025 – 2027

Yokohama, Kanagawa, Japan

Master of Media Design

Advisors: Mauricio Sousa, Kouta Minamizawa

The Cooper Union for the Advancement of Science and Art 2017 – 2020

New York, NY, United States

Bachelor of Fine Arts

GPA: 3.67

Washington University in St. Louis 2015 – 2017

St. Louis, MO, United States

Coursework toward the Bachelor of Fine Arts in Communication Design and the Bachelor of Arts in Music; transferred to The Cooper Union

GPA: 3.67; Dean's List, 3 semesters

Publications

Peer-reviewed conference papers

Ito: Real-time Browser Tab Orchestration Through Intent Detection 2026

Elvin Hu, Jasmine Sumpter, Takatoshi Yoshida, Mauricio Sousa, and Kouta Minamizawa.

Proceedings of the 39th Annual ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST '26), Detroit, MI, USA. ACM. Conditionally accepted.

Granted patents

Display screen or portion thereof with transitional graphical user interface 2023

US Patent D1098139. Filed August 2023; granted October 2025. Assignee: Google LLC.

Covers the generative interface companion for mobile browsing.

Display screen or portion thereof with transitional graphical user interface 2023
US Patent D1098140. Filed August 2023; granted October 2025. Assignee: Google LLC.
Covers the generative interface companion for mobile browsing.

Pending patents

Tab grouping for an application 2024
US Publication 2025/0068305. Filed August 2024. Shipped as Auto Tab Group.

Compose assistant manager for an application 2024
US Publication 2025/0068833. Filed August 2024. Shipped as Help Me Write.

Systems and methods for utilizing generative models to generate a personalized interactive summary of content 2023
US Publication 2025/0190719. Filed December 2023.
Productionized as Daily Listen in the Google Search app.

Defensive publication

Automatic personalization of user interfaces based on user interaction analytics 2021
On-device personalization from user behavioral signals; shipped as Adaptive Toolbar Shortcut.

Experience

Embodied Media Lab, Keio Media Design 2026 – Present
Tokyo, Japan. Advisors: Mauricio Sousa, Kouta Minamizawa.

- **Implicit-signal interaction.** Research on interfaces that make sense of behavior a person is not deliberately producing.
- **Methods.** Systems engineering, field deployment studies, and autoethnography.

Google – Design Lead (Senior Designer), Chrome 2023 – 2024
San Francisco, California, United States. Design Lead.

- **Chrome GenAI Innovation and Coherence.** Initiated and led the workstream. Built a focused short-term roadmap with leads and partners across Google and brought it to life with feature designers, shipping Chrome’s first four Gemini-powered features: Help Me Write, Auto Tab Groups, and Create Theme with AI, and Gemini in Omnibox.
- **Long-term GenAI vision.** Drove a prototyping effort exploring Chrome’s direction, and represented Chrome in the Google AI Studio, the cross-team group responsible for AI consistency across Google products.

Google – Design Lead (UX Designer III), Chrome 2021 – 2023
San Francisco, California, United States.

- **Chrome on Android.** Lead designer for a browser serving 2.5 billion users, responsible for core interface design, design systems refresh, and reviewing feature teams’ design proposals.
- **Chrome on novel form factors.** Led a team of four to redesign Chrome for Pixel Fold and Pixel Tablet ahead of launch, introducing improvements to drag and drop, window management, and desktop-site browsing; supported the Android XR team in adapting Chrome for XR devices.

- **Chrome brand.** Initiated the effort and led a team to refresh Chrome’s brand for the first time in eight years, making it feel contemporary, accessible, and in tune with the OS.
- **Built-in intelligence.** Integrated on-device intelligence into Chrome for Android, including personalized UI driven by user-action modeling and a contextual toolbar button.
- **Mentorship.** Managed one intern and mentored two new hires.

Google – UX Designer II, Chrome

2020 – 2021

San Francisco, California, United States.

- **Material You in Chrome.** Led adoption of Google’s new design language in Chrome for Android, contributed to the Google-wide language, and drove the refresh of Chrome for Android’s design documentation.
- **Chrome widgets for iOS.** Designed and developed three widgets in SwiftUI on a four-week timeline.
- **Tab management.** Led design for tab organization in Chrome on iOS.

Google – Design Intern, Material Design

2019

San Francisco, California, United States.

- **Material Theme Builder.** Generated themed design systems via color extraction from images; became the seed for the company-wide Material You effort.
- **Material Design documentation.** Built in-line interactive explanations helping developers understand color scales and dark theme, and designed and developed the Figma Material Theme Creator plug-in.

Honors and awards

Platform & Ecosystems Award (SVP-level), Google

2022

For contributions to on-device machine learning in Chrome (the “magic toolbar”).

Platform & Ecosystems Award (SVP-level), Google

2022

For leading the adoption of Material You in Chrome.

Award of Excellence, Communication Arts Typography Annual

2020

Musical Script Book Covers

Winner, Communication Design, Type Directors Club (TDC66)

2020

Musical Script Book Covers

Red Dot Award

2020

Musical Script Book Covers

Talks and panels

Designing Across Cultures

[Year]

Tokyo Design Forum. Panelist, with Xinni C. and Wakana Sakai.

Technical skills

Research methods

Systems building and evaluation, field deployment studies, autoethnography and autobiographical design, semi-structured interviews, qualitative coding, sensor-data analysis.

Programming tools

Swift, JavaScript, TypeScript, Python

Languages

English, Mandarin, Japanese (advanced, N1-level competence)